today, though historian Syed Ali Nadeem Rezavi has brought many new elements to light.

Part 4 (1579–1585) focuses on the court at Fatehpur Sikri as Akbar starts his philosophical discussions in the ibadat khana. The composition of the nobility changes as Akbar consciously balances the Turki–Chaghatai noblemen with Rajput and Persian officers. Many Hindu elements are incorporated into Mughal etiquette, and the translation of the Mahabharat into Persian is undertaken. Akbar also neutralizes the last remaining challenge from a Timurid prince, his half-brother Mirza Hakim. Now Akbar is free to create a new Hindustani identity composed of many different elements and beliefs.

In Part 5 (1585–1598) the court relocates once again, this time to Lahore, to stabilize the volatile situation in the north-western frontier of the empire. Kashmir is incorporated into the Mughal Empire and Akbar travels to Srinagar three times. He commissions great works of history, including the enormous *Akbarnama* and *Ain-i Akbari* by Abu'l Fazl, as he starts on his grand project to anchor his life and his lineage in the fabric of Hindustan's memory. As Akbar's three sons grow up, the atmosphere at court becomes charged with jealousies and rivalries as each prince begins to attract noblemen to his cause. The works of art created at this time are more sober, meditative, and exquisite. Mughal artists begin experimenting with European ideas of space and perspective as the Jesuits bring European art to the Mughal court.

In Part 6 (1598–1605), Akbar leaves Lahore as the Mughals make inroads into the Deccan. His capital moves back to Agra. There is a slackening of ambition as the Padshah becomes more and more caught up in a battle of wills with his sons, especially Salim. Salim rebels by establishing a parallel court at Allahabad and creates his own taswir khana (atelier), consciously distancing himself from his father's preferred Hindustani style and patronizing a more Persian style. These last years of Akbar's life are dominated by these rebellions from his sons and the catastrophic consequences of their decisions.

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Despite his many superhuman achievements Akbar remains endearingly human, almost surprisingly so. Too often when we imagine Akbar, it is as a somewhat one-dimensional, bloodless cutout. Many see him as a perfect man, a 'great' ruler, and an exemplary human being. He is also seen,